

ACME CORPORATION

Employee Handbook & HR Policy Manual

Effective Date: January 1, 2026 | Version 3.2

Section 1: Leave and Time-Off Policy

1.1 Annual Leave: All full-time employees are entitled to 21 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued at a rate of 1.75 days per month. Unused leave up to a maximum of 10 days may be carried forward into the following calendar year. Any leave beyond this cap will be forfeited unless otherwise approved in writing by the Head of HR.

1.2 Sick Leave: Employees are entitled to 12 days of paid sick leave annually. A medical certificate is required for any sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days. Sick leave does not carry forward to the next year.

1.3 Maternity and Paternity Leave: Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave. Male employees are entitled to 10 days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth.

1.4 Bereavement Leave: Employees may take up to 5 paid days of bereavement leave in the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling).

Section 2: Resignation and Notice Period

2.1 Notice Period: Employees wishing to resign must provide written notice to their reporting manager and the HR department. The required notice period is 60 days for employees at the Manager level and above, and 30 days for all other employees.

2.2 Buyout of Notice Period: At the Company's sole discretion, an employee may pay an amount equivalent to their gross salary for the unserved notice period in lieu of working through the full notice period. This request must be approved by both the employee's manager and HR.

2.3 Exit Interview: All departing employees are required to complete an exit interview with HR prior to their last working day. Final settlement, including any pending reimbursements and leave encashment, will be processed within 45 days of the last working day.

2.4 Return of Company Property: Employees must return all company property, including laptops, access cards, and mobile devices, on or before their last working day. Failure to do so may result in deductions from the final settlement amount.

Section 3: Code of Conduct

3.1 Workplace Behavior: Employees are expected to maintain professional conduct at all times. Harassment, discrimination, or bullying of any kind will not be tolerated and may result in immediate termination.

3.2 Conflict of Interest: Employees must disclose any outside business activities, financial interests, or relationships that could reasonably be seen to conflict with the interests of the Company. Disclosures should be made in writing to the Compliance Officer.

3.3 Confidentiality: All employees must protect confidential company information, including but not limited to client data, financial records, and proprietary technology, both during and after employment with the Company.

3.4 Remote Work Policy: Employees approved for remote work must be available during core business hours of 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time and must attend all scheduled video meetings with cameras enabled unless otherwise agreed with their manager.

Section 4: Compensation and Benefits

4.1 Salary Reviews: Annual salary reviews are conducted every April, based on individual performance ratings and overall company performance. Salary increments typically range from 0% to 15%.

4.2 Health Insurance: The Company provides group health insurance coverage of up to INR 5,00,000 per year for the employee and up to 3 dependents (spouse and up to 2 children).

4.3 Provident Fund: The Company contributes 12% of basic salary to the Employee Provident Fund (EPF), matched by an equal employee contribution, in accordance with statutory requirements.

4.4 Performance Bonus: Eligible employees may receive an annual performance bonus of up to 20% of their annual base salary, subject to individual and company performance against targets set at the start of the fiscal year.